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PSAC Exam Practice — Mauritius

2026

Grade 6 • Science

Specimen Paper 2

Time allowed: **1 hour 45 minutes**

Total marks: **100**

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

Date: _____

Index No.: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, school and index number clearly on this paper.
2. Answer **ALL** questions in **ALL FOUR** sections.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided on this paper.
4. All diagrams must be neat, clearly labelled and drawn in pencil.
5. The marks for each question are shown in square brackets [].
6. Calculators and electronic devices are **NOT** permitted.
7. Where working is required, show all steps clearly.

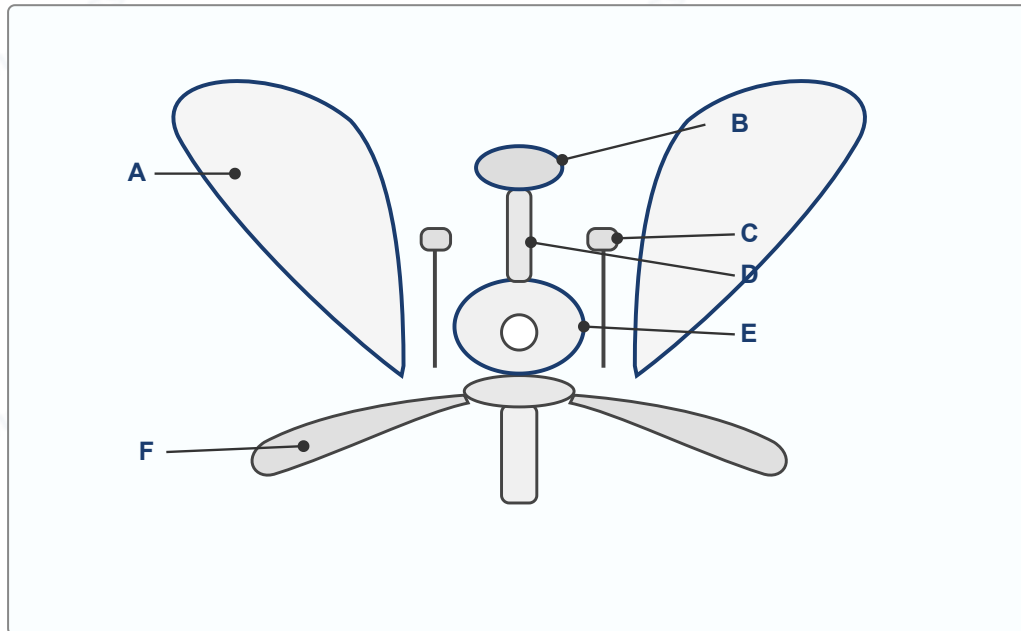
Section	Topic	Available	Awarded
A	Living Things — Reproduction in Plants & Animals	30	
B	Matter — Mixtures & Separation	25	
C	Energy — Sound	25	
D	Earth & Space — The Water Cycle	20	

Section	Topic	Available	Awarded
TOTAL		100	

SECTION A — Living Things: Reproduction in Plants & Animals [30 marks]

- 1 The diagram below shows a cross-section of a flower. Study it carefully and answer the questions.

[10]



- (a) Write the name of each labelled part A–F of the flower. [6]

A: _____ B: _____
C: _____ D: _____
E: _____ F: _____

- (b) What is pollination? Name **two** agents of pollination. [3]

- (c) After fertilisation, what does the ovary develop into? [1]

2 This question is about seed dispersal in plants.

[10]

- (a) Explain why it is important for seeds to be dispersed away from the parent plant.

[2]

- (b) For each seed below, state the method of dispersal and describe the feature that helps it disperse.

[6]

Seed / Fruit	Method of Dispersal	Helpful Feature
Dandelion		
Coconut		
Balsam (touch-me-not)		

- (c) Name **two** conditions that a seed needs to germinate (begin to grow).

[2]

1. _____ 2. _____

3 This question is about reproduction in animals.

[10]

- (a) State the difference between *sexual reproduction* and *asexual reproduction*.

[2]

- (b) Sort the following animals into *oviparous* (egg-laying) and *viviparous* (live birth) in the table.

Hen, Dolphin, Crocodile, Human, Turtle, Bat, Salmon, Cat

[4]

Oviparous (lay eggs)	Viviparous (give birth to live young)

- (c) Describe **two** ways in which mammals care for their young after birth.

[2]

- (d) Give **one** example of a plant that reproduces asexually, and name the method it uses.

[2]

SECTION B — Matter: Mixtures & Separation [25 marks]

4 This question is about solutions and solubility.

[8]

- (a) When sugar is added to water, it dissolves. Write the correct scientific term for each of the following:

[3]

The substance that dissolves (sugar): _____

The liquid it dissolves in (water): _____

The result of mixing them: _____

- (b) A pupil tests four substances by adding a spatula of each to water and stirring. The results are shown below. Classify each substance as *soluble* or *insoluble*.

[4]

Substance	Observation	Soluble or Insoluble?
Salt	Clear liquid	
Sand	Cloudy; grains settle	
Chalk powder	White cloudy liquid	
Sugar	Clear liquid	

- (c) Name **one** factor that can increase how quickly a solid dissolves in water.

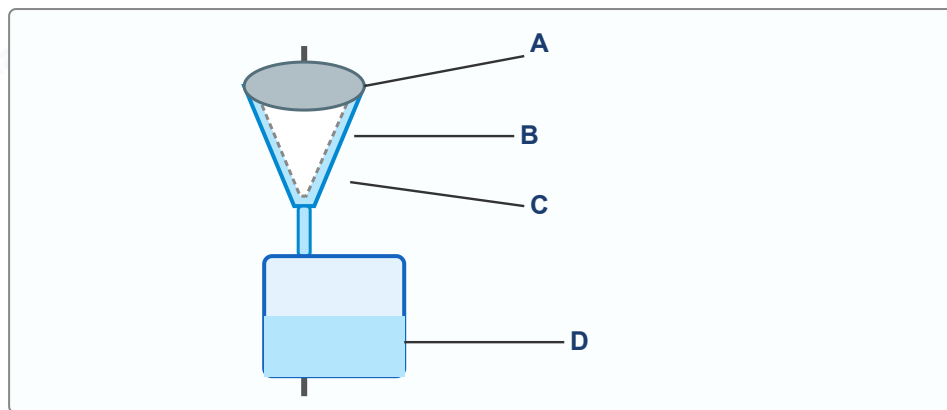
[1]

5 This question is about separating mixtures.

[9]

- (a) The diagram below shows apparatus used to separate a mixture. Label the parts A–D and name the separation technique being used.

[5]



A: _____ B: _____

C: _____ D: _____

Technique: _____

- (b) A pupil wants to recover pure salt from a saltwater solution. Describe the method they should use, step by step.

[3]

- (c) Which technique would you use to separate oil from water? Give a reason.

[1]

6 This question is about materials and their properties.

[8]

- (a) What is the difference between a *pure substance* and a *mixture*? Give one example of each.

[4]

- (b) A pupil mixes flour and water to make dough. Is this a reversible or irreversible change? Explain your answer.

[2]

- (c) Name **two** properties of metals that make them useful for making cooking pots.

[2]

1. _____
2. _____

SECTION C — Energy: Sound [25 marks]

7 This question is about the production and travel of sound.

[8]

- (a) How is sound produced? Give **two** examples of objects that produce sound by vibrating.

[3]

- (b) Can sound travel through a vacuum (empty space)? Explain your answer.

[2]

- (c) In which medium does sound travel **fastest**: solid, liquid, or gas? Give a reason for your answer.

[2]

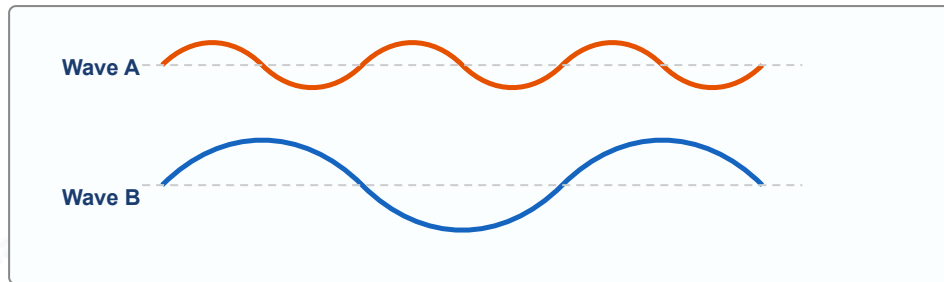
- (d) What is an echo? Name one place where you might hear an echo.

[1]

8 This question is about the properties of sound: pitch and loudness.

[9]

- (a) The diagram below shows two sound waves A and B on a screen. Use the diagram to answer the questions.



- (i) Which wave has a higher pitch? Explain how you can tell.[2]

- (ii) Which wave is louder? Explain how you can tell.[2]

- (b) A guitar has thick and thin strings. Which string will produce a higher pitch when plucked? Explain why.

[2]

- (c) State **one** harmful effect of very loud sounds on the human body, and **one** way to protect yourself from it.

[2]

(d) What is the unit used to measure the loudness of sound?

[1]

9 This question is about hearing and uses of sound.

[8]

- (a) Describe, step by step, how sound travels from a ringing bell to your brain so you can hear it.

[4]

- (b) Animals such as bats and dolphins use sound to find their way and locate food. What is the name of this technique?

[1]

- (c) A doctor uses an ultrasound scanner to see inside a patient. State **one** advantage of ultrasound over X-rays for this purpose.

[1]

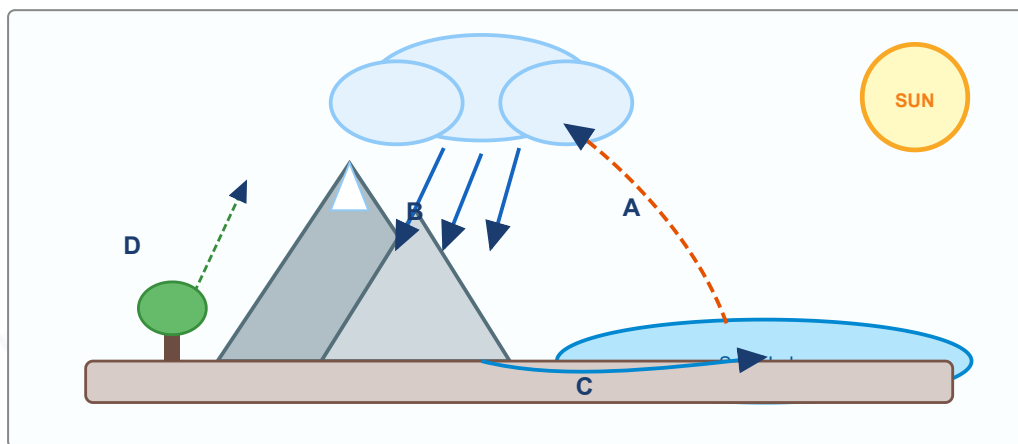
- (d) Sound takes 3 seconds to travel to a cliff and back as an echo. If the speed of sound in air is 340 m/s, how far away is the cliff?

[2]

SECTION D — Earth & Space: The Water Cycle [20 marks]

- 10 The diagram below shows the water cycle. Study it and answer the questions.

[10]



- (a) Name the processes labelled A–D in the water cycle diagram.

[4]

A:

B:

C:

D:

- (b) Explain why water evaporates more quickly on a sunny, windy day than on a cold, still day.

[2]

- (c) Where does the energy that drives the water cycle come from?

[1]

- (d) How do clouds form? Explain the process using the terms *water vapour*, *rises*, *cools*, and *condenses*.

[3]

11 This question is about weather patterns and water resources.

[10]

(a) Name the instrument used to measure each of the following:
[3]

Rainfall:

Temperature:

Wind speed:

(b) Mauritius sometimes experiences droughts (long periods of no rain). Suggest **two** ways in which people can conserve water during a drought.

[2]

(c) Describe how fresh water is treated (purified) before it is safe to drink. Include at least **three** stages in your answer.

[3]

(d) Why is it important to protect rivers and lakes from pollution? Give **two** reasons.

[2]

END OF PAPER 2 — Check all your answers carefully before handing in.

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 2 (2026) • Grade 6 Science

For teachers and parents: Accept any answer that demonstrates equivalent scientific understanding. Where wording differs, award the mark if the key concept is clearly expressed. Answers in *italics* are alternative acceptable responses. This paper is for practice purposes only. Produced by Noukclass.com.

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1	(a)	A=Petal, B=Stigma, C=Stamen/Anther, D=Style, E=Ovary, F=Sepal [1 each]	6
	(b)	Pollination = transfer of pollen from anther to stigma [1]. Agents: wind, insects/bees, water, animals [any 2, 1 each]	3
	(c)	Fruit (containing seeds)	1
2	(a)	To avoid overcrowding / competition for light, water, nutrients with the parent plant. [1 per valid reason, max 2]	2
	(b)	Dandelion: wind; parachute/fluffy structure. Coconut: water; buoyant (floats). Balsam: explosive/self-dispersal; seed pod bursts open. [1 per method + feature pair]	6
	(c)	Any two from: warmth/suitable temperature, water/moisture, oxygen, light. [1 each]	2
3	(a)	Sexual: requires two parents, gametes join (fertilisation), offspring have variation. Asexual: one parent, no gametes, offspring are identical clones. [1 per correct contrast]	2
	(b)	Oviparous: Hen, Crocodile, Turtle, Salmon. Viviparous: Dolphin, Human, Bat, Cat. [1 per column fully correct]	4
	(c)	Any two: feed young with milk (suckle); keep young warm; protect from predators; teach young to find food. [1 each]	2
	(d)	Example: Strawberry (runners); Potato (tubers); Onion (bulbs); Spider plant (offshoots). Method = name of asexual method used. [1+1]	2
4	(a)	Solute = sugar; Solvent = water; Solution = sugar solution (or salt solution). [1 each]	3
	(b)	Salt=soluble; Sand=insoluble; Chalk=insoluble; Sugar=soluble. [1 each]	4
	(c)	Any one: increase temperature/heating; stirring; crushing/grinding the solid into smaller pieces. [1]	1
5	(a)	A=Mixture (sand and water); B=Filter paper; C=Residue (sand); D=Filtrate (water). Technique	5

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
		= Filtration. [1 each]	
	(b)	Pour the saltwater into an evaporating dish; heat gently (e.g. over a Bunsen burner or using sunlight); water evaporates leaving solid salt crystals behind. [1 per step, max 3]	3
	(c)	Decanting / using a separating funnel; because oil and water do not mix (they are immiscible) and oil floats on water. [1]	1
6	(a)	Pure substance = made of one type of particle/one element or compound; cannot be separated by physical means. Example: pure water, gold. Mixture = two or more substances mixed together but not chemically joined; can be separated. Example: saltwater, air. [2 per correct definition + example pair]	4
	(b)	Reversible; the dough can be dried/the water evaporated to get flour back (approximate). <i>Accept irreversible if pupil justifies that it cannot fully return to flour — award mark for correct justification.</i>	2
	(c)	Any two: good conductor of heat; strong/durable; does not melt easily (high melting point); does not react with food. [1 each]	2
7	(a)	Sound is produced by vibrations. Examples: guitar string vibrating; drum skin vibrating; vocal cords vibrating. [1 + 1 per example, max 3]	3
	(b)	No; sound requires a medium (particles) to travel through. A vacuum has no particles, so sound cannot travel. [1+1]	2
	(c)	Solid; particles in a solid are closer together and more tightly packed, so vibrations are passed on more quickly. [1+1]	2
	(d)	An echo is a reflected sound. Example: in a cave, tunnel, or near a cliff. [1]	1
8	(a)(i)	Wave A has higher pitch; it has a higher frequency (more waves in the same space / shorter wavelength). [1+1]	2
	(a)(ii)	Wave B is louder; it has a larger amplitude (taller wave / greater height from centre line). [1+1]	2
	(b)	Thin string; it vibrates faster (higher frequency) than the thick string, producing a higher pitch. [1+1]	2
	(c)	Harmful effect: hearing damage/deafness/tinnitus. Protection: wear ear defenders/earmuffs; move away from the source. [1+1]	2
8 cont.	(d)	Decibel (dB)	1
9	(a)	Bell vibrates → sends sound waves through air → sound waves enter ear canal → hit eardrum,	4

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
		making it vibrate → vibrations travel through ossicles (small bones) → reach cochlea → signal sent to brain via auditory nerve. [1 per step, max 4]	
	(b)	Echolocation (sonar)	1
	(c)	Ultrasound is safe (no harmful radiation); it does not use ionising radiation. <i>Accept: it can show soft tissue in real time.</i>	1
	(d)	Distance = (speed × time) ÷ 2 = (340 × 3) ÷ 2 = 1020 ÷ 2 = 510 m . [1 for method, 1 for correct answer]	2
10	(a)	A = Evaporation; B = Precipitation (rainfall/condensation); C = Surface run-off; D = Transpiration. [1 each]	4
	(b)	Sunshine provides energy to evaporate water faster [1]; wind blows water vapour away, keeping the air above the water drier so more evaporates [1]. [1 each]	2
	(c)	The Sun	1
	(d)	Water evaporates from surfaces and rises as water vapour [1]; as it rises it cools [1]; the cooled vapour condenses [1] around tiny dust particles to form water droplets, which make up clouds [1]. [1 per key term correctly used, max 3]	3
11	(a)	Rainfall: rain gauge; Temperature: thermometer; Wind speed: anemometer. [1 each]	3
	(b)	Any two: take shorter showers; fix leaking taps; collect rainwater; water plants with a watering can (not a hose); reduce garden watering. [1 each]	2
	(c)	Any three stages: screening (remove large debris); sedimentation (particles settle); filtration (through sand/gravel); chlorination/disinfection (kill bacteria); <i>aeration/pH adjustment</i> . [1 per stage, max 3]	3
	(d)	Any two: rivers provide drinking water for humans; support wildlife / aquatic ecosystems; used for irrigation; pollution harms fish and other organisms; affects human health. [1 each]	2
TOTAL			100